

AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. — Work From Home Policy

Section 1: Purpose / Definition

AstraNova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. (hereinafter called "AstraNova" or "the Company") values flexibility and work-life balance. The Work From Home Policy sets clear rules for working outside the office. It helps employees remain productive while keeping company data safe and secure.

Section 2: Scope

This policy applies to all permanent employees and interns at AstraNova who can do their work using a computer and a stable internet connection. It covers both hybrid staff (who split time between home and the office) and approved full-time remote staff.

Section 3: Eligibility

All permanent employees can use the hybrid work model from their first day of joining. Full-time work from home is not standard. It requires special written approval from your Department Head and the HR Director, based on your job role and performance.

Section 4: Rules & Guidelines

4.1 Home Work Space and Internet

Employees must set up a quiet, private space at home to work without distractions. You must have a fast and reliable internet connection with at least 50 Mbps speed. The Company provides a standard laptop. You are responsible for keeping your home workspace safe and connected.

4.2 Core Working Hours

Working from home does not mean flexible hours. You must be online and available during our core company hours from 11:00 AM to 4:00 PM IST, Monday through Friday. You must keep your Slack status updated and join all team video meetings with your camera turned on when asked.

4.3 Data and IT Security

Security is a top priority for AstraNova. You must only use your company laptop for work. Never use a personal computer or tablet. You must log in using the official company VPN and use Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) every day. Do not share

your passwords with anyone, including family members. Do not paste any company code or private data into public AI tools.

Section 5: Process / Workflow

To apply for a work from home schedule, follow these simple steps:

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Employee talks to their Reporting Manager about the schedule
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Employee fills out the Work From Home form in the HRIS portal
↓
Manager checks team schedules and clicks Approve or Reject
↓
HR team reviews the request and updates the company system
↓
IT team activates secure remote access and VPN controls
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Section 6: Roles & Responsibilities

6.1 Employee

- Stay online and answer messages during core hours.
- Keep company data safe and follow all IT security rules.
- Finish your daily tasks and sprint goals on time.

6.2 Reporting Manager

- Check team progress based on daily output, not physical presence.
- Ensure the team has enough support and regular communication.
- Approve or reject home work requests fairly.

6.3 HR & IT Teams

- HR tracks work schedules and helps resolve employee issues.
- IT provides technical support and monitors network security.

Section 7: Exceptions

7.1 Power and Network Outages

If your home internet or power goes out for more than two hours during the workday, you must call your manager right away. Your manager may ask you to travel to the Pune office or make up the missed hours later.

7.2 Performance and Security Issues

If an employee fails to meet their performance goals or violates IT security rules, their work from home privileges will be canceled immediately. The employee will have to work full-time from the Pune office.

Section 8: Examples

- **Scenario A (Sudden Home Internet Failure):** A tester is working from home when their broadband stops working at 12:00 PM. The tester calls their manager immediately. Since the fix will take all day, the manager tells the tester to use a mobile hotspot for critical text updates and log the remaining hours the next day.
- **Scenario B (Working from a Different Location):** An engineer needs to visit family in another city for a week. The engineer asks their manager ten days in advance. The manager approves the request in the HRIS because the engineer promises to stay online during core hours and use the company VPN.

Section 9: Important Notes

- **Avoid:** Do not work from public places like coffee shops or airports using public Wi-Fi. This leaks company data and violates our security rules.
- **Best Practice:** Check your laptop charger, mouse, and internet backup options before your shift starts each morning to avoid missing team meetings.

Section 10: Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q1: What are the core hours when I work from home?

A1: You must be online, active, and available on Slack between 11:00 AM and 4:00 PM IST, Monday through Friday.

Q2: Can I use my personal computer to work from home?

A2: No. You must only use the official laptop provided by AstraNova to protect company data.

Q3: Does the company pay for my home internet?

A3: Yes. You can claim a monthly internet bill refund through the HRIS portal up to the limit set for your job role.

Q4: Can I work from home if I am on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP)?

A4: No. Employees on a PIP must work from the physical Pune office to receive direct help and guidance from their manager.

Q5: What should I do if I forget to check in on the HRIS portal at home?

A5: Submit a regularization request in the HRIS portal the next day, and ask your manager to approve your actual work hours.

Q6: Can I share my company laptop with my family members?

A6: No. Your laptop is for your work use only. Sharing your device or passwords violates our security policy.

Q7: Who should I call if my company VPN stops working at home?

A7: You should contact the IT support helpdesk immediately by phone or email to get the connection fixed.

Q8: Can I work from home full-time?

A8: Our standard model is hybrid (two days in the office). Full-time remote work needs special written approval from your Department Head and HR.

Q9: Do I need to turn on my camera during online meetings?

A9: Yes. Turning on your camera is mandatory for all team syncs and client meetings to ensure good communication.

Q10: What happens if I do not answer messages during core hours?

A10: Unmatched delays or missing core hours without a valid reason will be marked as an unexcused absence by your manager.